

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 905

By Slater

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Frances Ogeal Halfacre Webster on the celebration of her 100th birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Frances Ogeal Halfacre Webster celebrates her 100th birthday on February 16, 2026, a milestone commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, the daughter of B. and Georgie Ann Roberts Halfacre, Ogeal Webster was born on the banks of the Cumberland River in Granville; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Webster has lived a blessed life, having experienced firsthand the most eventful and productive years in American history; and

WHEREAS, joined in holy matrimony on July 31, 1948, she enjoyed fifty-two years of marriage with her husband, William Clyde Webster, before his passing in 2000; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Webster is the mother of two children: a son, William Donald Webster, born in 1958, and a daughter, Melinda Ann, adopted in 1962; and

WHEREAS, Ogeal Webster attended school in Granville for grades one through ten and then attended Jackson County Central High School in Gainesboro, from which she graduated; she received her college degree in 1946 from Tennessee Polytechnic Institute, known today as Tennessee Technological University; and

WHEREAS, in 1946, Ms. Webster began her thirty-one-year career as an educator at the high school in Columbia, serving as a physical education instructor and girls' basketball coach; throughout her career, she also taught in Greeneville, Roane County, Hartsville, and Gallatin as a science teacher; her fellow teachers gave her the nickname "Jill," by which name she is still called today by many friends and family; and

WHEREAS, a gracious and generous woman, Ogeal Webster has always been interested in helping others and serving her community; she and her husband contributed much time and service to help the 4-H program in Tennessee and were inducted into the 4-H Donors Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Webster was also very active in supporting the Granville Museum project in her hometown; in 2009, she dedicated the B. and Georgie Halfacre Storytelling Stage, located beside the Sutton Store in Granville, in memory of her parents; and

WHEREAS, not only an educator and public servant, Ogeal Webster is a published author and playwright; in 2009, she published her first book, *Growing Up on the Cumberland River*, which highlighted the history of Granville and her early life; her second book, *Bananas in the Promised Land*, was a historical account that highlighted the region during the steamboat era; the play she authored, *Journey to the Promised Land*, was performed in Granville in 2015; and

WHEREAS, a beloved family matriarch, Ms. Webster lived in Cookeville but then moved to Georgia to be closer to her son, Don; in 2022, Ms. Webster and her son moved back to Hartsville and settled down on the Cumberland River, the same river she grew up on; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Frances Ogeal Halfacre Webster on the celebration of her 100th birthday and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

